

Deadlift Form Guide

A short reference for the conventional barbell deadlift. Read the setup section carefully; most technique problems start before the bar leaves the floor.

Setup

Stand with the bar over mid-foot, feet hip-width apart. Hinge at the hips and grip the bar just outside your legs. Drop your hips until your shins touch the bar, chest up, back flat. Take the slack out of the bar before pulling.

The pull

Push the floor away with your legs while keeping the bar in contact with your shins and thighs. Hips and shoulders rise at the same rate. Finish tall by squeezing the glutes; do not lean back at the top.

The descent

Hinge at the hips first, sliding the bar down your thighs. Bend the knees once the bar passes them. Keep the back flat; lowering is not a controlled collapse.

Common mistakes

Rounding the lower back, jerking the bar off the floor, letting the bar drift away from the body, and hyperextending at lockout. If any of these appear, reduce the weight and rebuild the pattern.